

Class 17

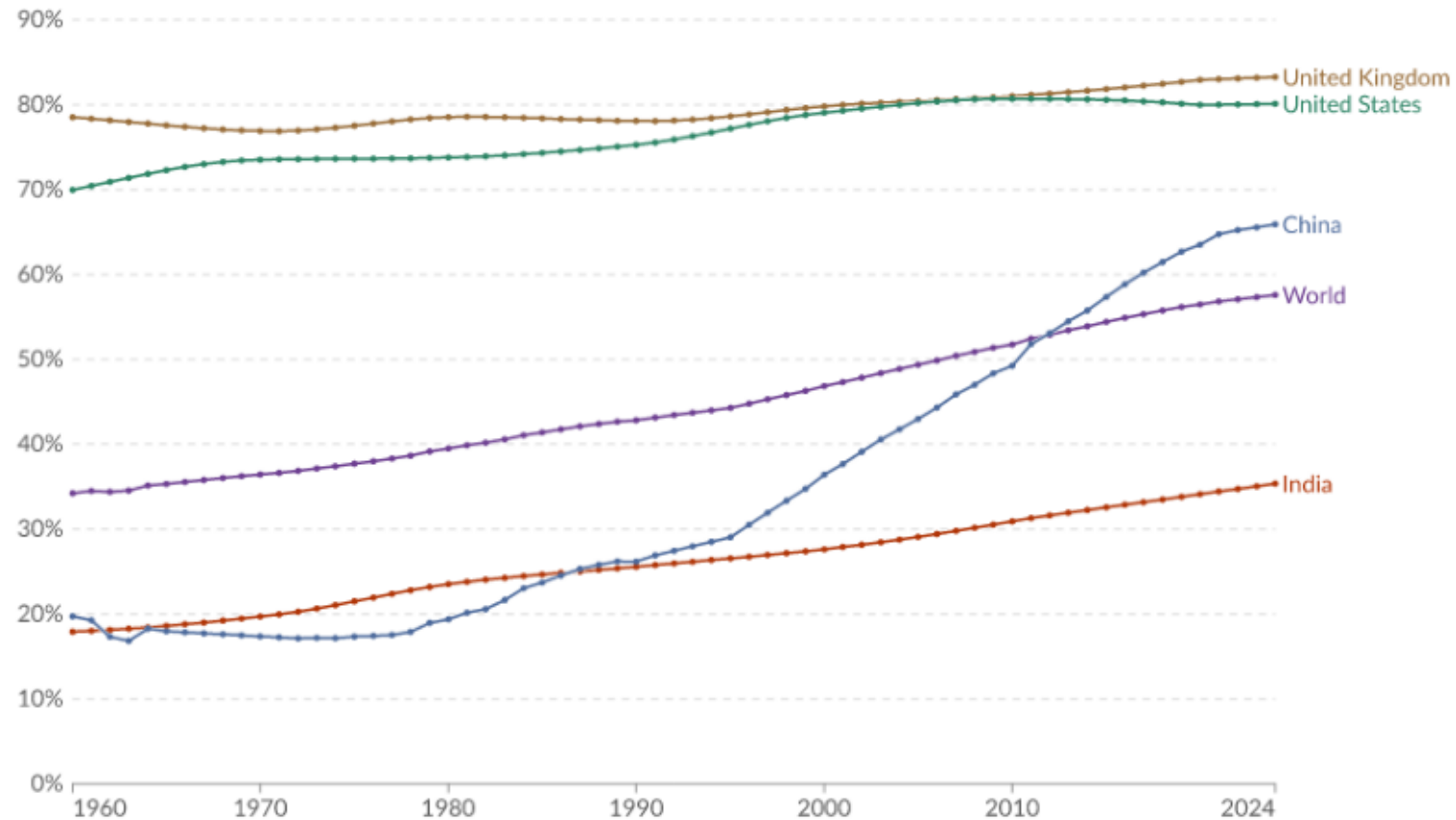
Cities, Housing, and Path Dependence

Part III — Mobilizing People and Expanding Opportunity

From farms to cities: U.S. urbanization, 1790-present

Share of the population living in urban areas, 1960 to 2024

Our World
in Data



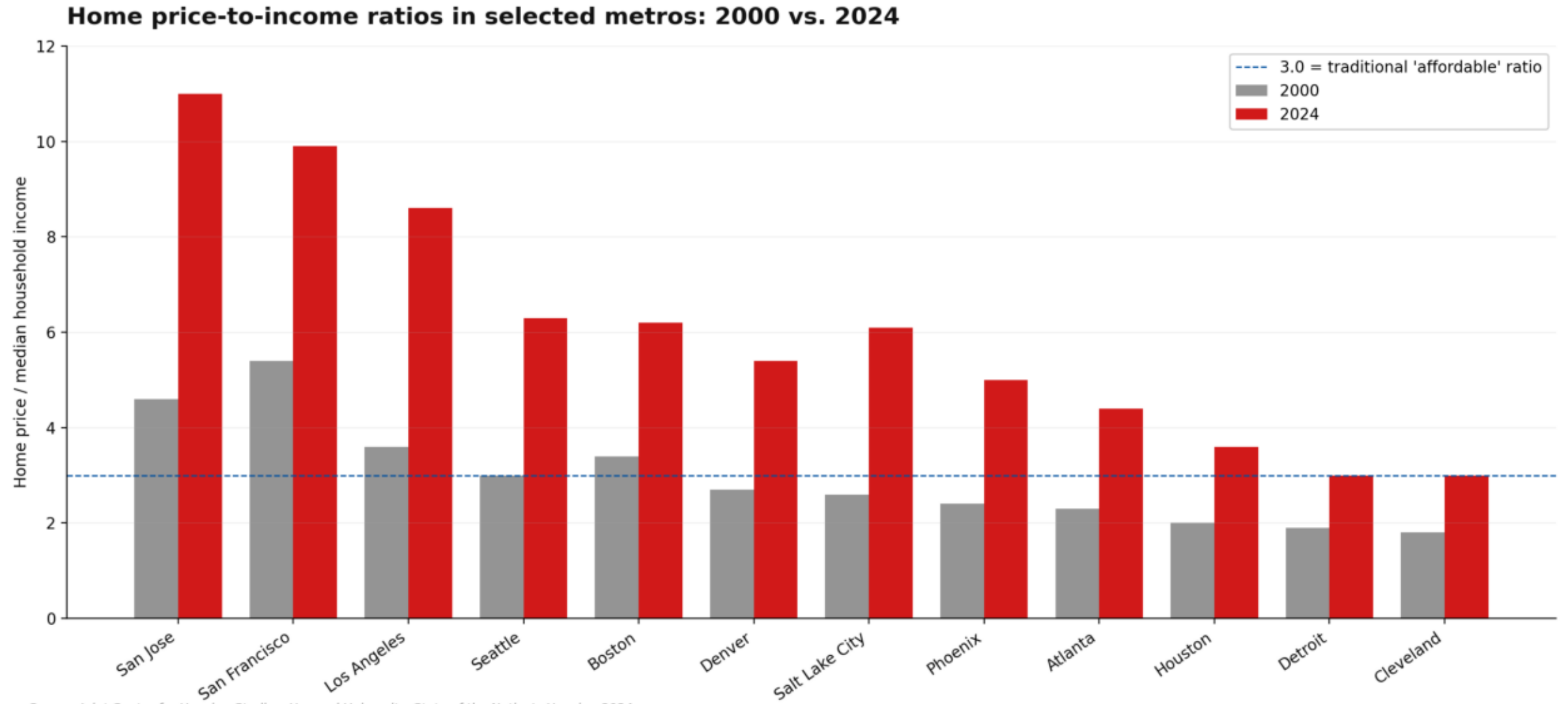
Data source: World Urbanization Prospects - UN Population Division, via World Bank (2026)

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Note: Because the estimates of city and metropolitan areas are based on national definitions of what constitutes a city or metropolitan area, cross-country comparisons should be made with caution.



Home price-to-income ratios in expensive cities



Source: Joint Center for Housing Studies, Harvard University, State of the Nation's Housing 2024.

Source: Joint Center for Housing Studies, Harvard University. National median reached 5times income in 2024.